

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

----- X

FRANCIS SHAUGHNESSY,

Plaintiff,

-against-

SUMMONS

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER
MOHAMED ELHANAFI, Shield No. 15082, SERGEANT
CHARLES MIELE, POLICE OFFICER SANCHEZ,
Shield No. 5340, and POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOES
NUMBERS ONE THROUGH TEN,

Index No.:

The Basis of Venue is:
Location of Incident

Defendants.

Plaintiff designates Kings
County as the place of trial.

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To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
May 19, 2018

Yours, etc.

/s/
JACOBS & HAZAN, LLP.
STUART E. JACOBS, ESQ.
Attorney for Plaintiff
30 Vesey Street, 4th Floor
New York, New York 10007
(212) 577-2690

TO: City of New York, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007
POLICE OFFICER MOHAMED ELHANAFI, Shield No. 15082, 79th Precinct, 263
Tompkins Ave, Brooklyn, NY 11216
SERGEANT CHARLES MIELE, 79th Precinct, 263 Tompkins Ave, Brooklyn, NY
11216
POLICE OFFICER SANCHEZ, Shield No. 5340, 79th Precinct, 263 Tompkins Ave,
Brooklyn, NY 11216

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

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FRANCIS SHAUGHNESSY,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER
MOHAMED ELHANAFI, Shield No. 15082, SERGEANT
CHARLES MIELE, POLICE OFFICER SANCHEZ,
Shield No. 5340, and POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOES
NUMBERS ONE THROUGH TEN,

Defendants.

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INDEX NO.:

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

JURY TRIAL DEMANDED

Plaintiff FRANCIS SHAUGHNESSY, by his attorneys, Jacobs & Hazan, LLP, as and for his Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the First, Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York. On February 18, 2017, at approximately 10:00 p.m., plaintiff Francis Shaughnessy, while lawfully in front of 395 Lexington Avenue, Brooklyn, New York, was subject to an unlawful stop, question, frisk, false arrest, and false imprisonment by the defendant New York City police officers. Plaintiff was also subject to assault, battery, and the use of excessive force when the defendant police officers slammed plaintiff against a wall, twisted his arms behind his back, and handcuffed him in an excessively tight and painful manner. Plaintiff was denied the right to due process and a fair trial when the defendant police officers forward false, misleading and incomplete information to the District Attorney's Office. Plaintiff was deprived of his constitutional and common law rights when the individual defendants unlawfully stop, questioned, frisked, assaulted, battered, used excessive force, confined, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned, and denied plaintiff the rights to due process and a fair trial in violation of the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York.

PARTIES

2. Plaintiff FRANCIS SHAUGHNESSY is a resident of the state of Pennsylvania.

3. POLICE OFFICER MOHAMED ELHANAFI, Shield No. 15082, is and was at all times relevant herein, an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

4. POLICE OFFICER MOHAMED ELHANAFI, Shield No. 15082, is and was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the 79th Precinct

5. POLICE OFFICER MOHAMED ELHANAFI, Shield No. 15082, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

6. SERGEANT CHARLES MIELE is and was at all times relevant herein, an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

7. SERGEANT CHARLES MIELE is and was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the 79th Precinct

8. SERGEANT CHARLES MIELE is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

9. POLICE OFFICER SANCHEZ, Shield No. 5340, and was at all times relevant herein, an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

10. POLICE OFFICER SANCHEZ, Shield No. 5340, is and was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the 79th Precinct

11. POLICE OFFICER SANCHEZ, Shield No. 5340, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

12. New York City Police Officers John Does #1-10 are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.

13. Police Officers John Does #1-10 are being sued in their individual and official capacities.

14. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and

employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.

15. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department, which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.

16. Plaintiff in furtherance of his causes of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the CITY OF NEW YORK in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50 and in accordance with New York State law.

17. In accordance with New York State law and General Municipal Law Section 50, plaintiff testified at a hearing held pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H on June 12, 2017.

18. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and THE CITY OF NEW YORK has failed to pay or adjust the claims.

19. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

20. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

21. On February 18, 2017, at approximately 10:00 p.m., plaintiff was lawfully in front of 395 Lexington Street, Brooklyn, when the defendant police officers unlawfully stopped, questioned, frisked, and searched plaintiff without reasonable suspicion or probable cause.

22. At no time relevant herein did plaintiff commit a crime or violate the law, nor did plaintiff behave in a manner that would lead a reasonable police officer to believe that plaintiff committed, was about to commit or was committing a crime.

23. Suddenly, without provocation or legal justification, the defendant officers grabbed plaintiff and slammed him against a wall.

24. The defendant police officers then twisted plaintiff's arms behind his back, causing plaintiff pain and injuries to plaintiff's left arm and wrist.

25. The assault, battery and use of excessive force against plaintiff were the direct and proximate causes of the serious physical injuries to his left arm and wrist.

26. At no time relevant herein did plaintiff act in a physical threatening manner towards the defendant police officers or anyone else, nor did plaintiff resist arrest in any way.

27. At no time relevant herein did the defendant police officers recover any drugs, guns or other contraband from plaintiff or from plaintiff's possession, custody or control.

28. Nevertheless, the defendant police officers unlawfully handcuffed and falsely arrested plaintiff.

29. At no point in time did plaintiff resist arrest in any way.

30. The handcuffs placed on plaintiff by the defendant police officers were unreasonably tight on plaintiff's wrists, causing plaintiff to suffer pain and discomfort.

31. Plaintiff told the defendant police officers that the handcuffs were hurting his wrists, and asked the defendant police officers to loosen the handcuffs, but the defendant police officers ignored plaintiff and failed to loosen the handcuffs.

32. The unreasonably tight handcuffs were the direct and proximate cause of the serious physical injuries to plaintiff's wrists.

33. Plaintiff was transported by the defendant police officers to the 79th Precinct against his will, where he was photographed, searched, fingerprinted and then placed in a holding cell by the defendants.

34. After approximately 5 hours in unlawful custody, plaintiff was transported to Kings County Central Booking and placed in a holding cell.

35. Based upon the false, misleading and/or incomplete information provided to the District Attorney's Office by the defendant police officers, a prosecution was initiated against plaintiff.

36. On February 19, 2017, at approximately 10:00 p.m., after being unlawfully detained for approximately 24 hours, plaintiff was arraigned in Kings County Criminal Court, charged with crimes he did not commit and for which the defendant police officers had no legal justification to accuse him of committing and he was released from custody.

37. Plaintiff was unlawfully charged with Obstruction of Governmental Administration in the Second Degree, Resisting Arrest, Disorderly Conduct, and Unlawfully Possession of Marijuana.

38. On August 18, 2017, all charges against plaintiff were dismissed and sealed in their entirety.

39. On February 21, 2017, plaintiff went to Easton Hospital to receive medical treatment for the injuries to his wrists and arms caused by the defendant police officers.

40. At Easton Hospital, Emergency Room staff conducted x-rays of plaintiff's left arm, diagnosed plaintiff with a strain of his left arm, and prescribed plaintiff pain medication.

41. As a result of the false arrest and imprisonment of plaintiff, plaintiff missed one day of work.

42. Some of the police officer defendants observed the violation of plaintiff's rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent the unjustifiable stop, question, frisk, search, seizure, false arrest and imprisonment, assault, battery, and use of excessive force against plaintiff.

43. The unlawful stop, question, frisk, search, seizure, false arrest and imprisonment, assault, battery, and use of excessive force against plaintiff by the individually named defendants caused plaintiff to sustain physical, psychological and emotional trauma.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights

44. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 43 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

45. The individually named police officer defendants while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused plaintiff to be seized, unlawfully searched, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned, and denied the right to due process and a fair trial, without reasonable suspicion and/or probable cause, in violation of plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

46. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, psychological and economic injuries.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest and False Imprisonment

47. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 46 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

48. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine plaintiff and, in fact, confined plaintiff, and plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

49. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

50. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

51. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

52. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, economic, emotional and psychological injuries.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Stop, Question, and Frisk

53. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 52 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

54. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop, questioning and frisk employed by defendants herein terminated plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

55. The conduct of defendants in stopping, frisking, and searching plaintiff were performed under color of law and without any reasonable suspicion of criminality or other constitutionally required grounds.

56. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

57. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

58. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

59. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, economic, emotional and psychological injuries.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Search

60. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 59 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

61. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop and search employed by defendants herein terminated plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

62. Defendants lacked probable cause to search plaintiff.

63. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

64. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

65. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

66. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth And Fourteenth Amendment

Rights

67. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 66 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

68. The use of excessive force by defendants by, amongst other things, by slamming plaintiff against the wall, twisting his arms behind his back, and handcuffing plaintiff in an excessively tight manner, constituted objectively unreasonable physical seizures of plaintiff in violation of his rights under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

69. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of his employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress

70. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 69 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

71. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to plaintiff, Francis Shaughnessy. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to plaintiff and violated plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

72. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to plaintiff and violated plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed plaintiff by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

73. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

74. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

75. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

76. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Denial of Right to Fair Trial

77. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 76 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein

78. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the District Attorney's Office.

79. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the District Attorney's Office.

80. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the District Attorney's Office.

81. In withholding/creating false evidence against plaintiff Francis Shaughnessy and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, defendants violated plaintiff's constitutional right to a fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments of the United States Constitution.

82. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiff Francis Shaughnessy sustained, inter alia, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, lost earnings and deprivation of his constitutional rights.

83. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

84. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

85. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligence

86. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 85 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

87. Defendants owed a duty of care to plaintiff.

88. To the extent defendants claim that the injuries to plaintiff's persons by the defendant police officers was unintentionally caused and that the force used by the defendants against his was unintentional, then the defendants breached that duty of care by accidentally and negligently handcuffing plaintiff in an excessively tight manner, and by assaulting and battering plaintiff.

89. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

90. All of the foregoing occurred without any fault or provocation by plaintiff.

91. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

92. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

93. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Assault

94. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 93 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

95. Defendants, their agents, servants and employees, acting within the scope of his employment, intentionally, willfully and maliciously assaulted plaintiff in that they had the real or apparent ability to cause imminent harmful and/or offensive bodily contact and intentionally did a violent and/or menacing act which threatened such contact to the plaintiff, that such acts caused apprehension of such contact in the plaintiff.

96. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

97. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

98. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

99. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Battery

100. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 99 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

101. Defendants, their agents, servants and employees, acting within the scope of their employment, intentionally, willfully and maliciously battered plaintiff, and with the intention of causing harmful and/or offensive bodily contact to the plaintiff and caused such battery.

102. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

103. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

104. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

105. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

ELEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision

106. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 105 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

107. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of police duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.

108. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

TWELVTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene

109. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 108 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

110. The defendants that did not physically touch plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to

intervene on behalf of plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

111. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.

112. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiff's liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, he was put in fear of his safety, and he was humiliated and subject to other physical constraints.

113. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

114. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

115. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

116. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

JURY DEMAND

117. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, plaintiff Francis Shaughnessy demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law. That the plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988.

Dated: New York, New York
May 19, 2018

By: /s/
STUART E. JACOBS
DAVID M. HAZAN
JACOBS & HAZAN, LLP
Attorneys for Plaintiff
30 Vesey Street, 4th Floor
New York, NY 10007
(212) 577-2690

TO: City of New York, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007
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Brooklyn, NY 11216

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

STUART E. JACOBS, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a partner of the law firm of **JACOBS & HAZAN, LLP**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
May 19, 2018

/s/
STUART E. JACOBS